

DR. TEKMAL SOLMANRAJ, Ph.D.

Sociologist | National Project Director | Former NFSC Fellow (Govt. of India) | Strategic WASH Infrastructure Analyst

Specializations: Socio-Technical Systems, Public Health Sociology, Resource Justice & Intersectional Marginalization

📍 **Location:** Nagulpallay Village, Watpally Mandal, Sangareddy District, Telangana, India – 502269

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🔗 PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Distinguished **Sociologist, National Project Director**, and **4-time UGC-NET qualifier** with an exceptional record of translating empirical social science into scalable rural development models. Expert in bridging complex engineering systems with grassroots realities by pioneering the framework of "**Infrastructural Dignity**" to evaluate Decentralized Wastewater Treatment Systems (**DEWATS**) and Fecal Sludge Management (**FSM**) against historical caste and gender hierarchies. Proven champion of UN Sustainable Development Goals (**SDG 5 & SDG 6**) with extensive field authority, competitive national grant execution background under the **Govt. of India**, and deep multi-stakeholder institutional trust.

🔑 CORE EXCELLENCE COMPETENCIES

- **Apex Project Management:** Competitive grant acquisition, fiscal stewardship, multi-site operational oversight, and ministerial reporting.
- **Socio-Technical Curricular Innovation:** Pioneer of specialized curricula bridging engineering pedagogy with social impact assessments and **Human-Centered Design**.

- **Advanced WASH Methodology:** Mastery of comparative multi-sited ethnography, **Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA)**, Focus Group Dynamics, and Socio-Technical Infrastructure Auditing.
 - **Strategic Field Mobilization:** Fluent trilingual capability (**Telugu, English, Hindi**) executing community engagement across marginalized rural and peri-urban demographics.
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CHRONOLOGICAL LEADERSHIP & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

National Project Director (Principal Investigator)

Indian Council of Social Science Research (ICSSR), Ministry of Education, Govt. of India |

2026 – Present

- **Grant Leadership:** Competitively secured and executing a **₹9,00,000** national research grant focusing on subaltern sanitation exclusions (**Project No: ICSSR-RMM-2025-7350**).
- **Theoretical Innovation:** Designed the interdisciplinary **Infrastructural Dignity Framework**, synthesis-mapping insights from Science and Technology Studies (STS), Feminist Political Ecology, and Dalit Studies.
- **Toolkit Development:** Leading the co-creation and field-validation of a participatory **Dignity-Centered Design (DCD) Audit Tool** for municipal engineers and state-level policy planners.
- **Policy Synthesis:** Directing a multi-tiered field research team to deliver empirical whitepapers directly to apex central ministries (**MoHUA, Ministry of Jal Shakti**).

Assistant Professor & Academic Unit Head (Sociology)

QIS College of Engineering & Technology (Autonomous, NAAC 'A+' Grade), Ongole, AP | Jul

2025 – Present

- **Pedagogical Architecture:** Pioneered and instituted a specialized "**Sociology for Engineers**" module to train technical cohorts in sociotechnical evaluation.

- **Living Laboratory Paradigm:** Engineered localized case-study modules evaluating real-world rural challenges (salinity intrusion, coastal erosion, agrarian distress) in the Prakasam district.
- **Experiential Learning Lead:** Officially administered student field groups executing mandatory **PRA, Social Mapping**, and technical infrastructure monitoring inside adopted rural settlements.

Assistant Professor (Humanities and Social Sciences)

Bhaskar Law College (Affiliated to Osmania University), Hyderabad, India | **Oct 2023 – July 2025**

- Instructed undergraduate cohorts on socio-legal frameworks, institutional stratification, and structural family modifications.
- Supervised academic writing exercises and trained researchers in localized qualitative field protocols.

Guest Faculty (Sociology)

Bhaskar College of Nursing, Hyderabad, India | **Nov 2024 – July 2025**

- Curated and delivered specialized modules on clinical sociology, translating public health models for remote rural healthcare deployments.

□ EMPIRICAL FIELDWORK EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Field Researcher & Institutional Collaborator

Sulabh International Social Service Organisation | **2022 – 2025**

- **Large-Scale Evaluative Studies:** Engineered and executed rigorous stratified sampling evaluations ($(N=258+)$) testing the on-ground efficacy of active sanitation interventions.
 - **Elite Mentorship:** Collaborated directly under the legendary sanitation pioneer **Padma Vibhushan Dr. Bindeshwar Pathak** to design human dignity and hygiene paradigms for rural India.
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HIGHER EDUCATION CREDENTIALS

- **Ph.D. in Sociology** | Central University of South Bihar, Gaya, India (**Awarded 2025**)
 - *Institutional Standing:* **UGC Category-1 Status & NAAC 'A++' Grade**
 - *Thesis Title:* "Socio-Psychological, Cultural and Economic problems of Widows of Vrindavan: A sociological Study"
 - *Supervision:* Prof. Anil Kumar Singh Jha (**Dean**) school of social science and policy
 - **M.A. in Sociology** | Central University of Haryana, Mahendragarh, India (**2017 – 2019**)
 - *Institutional Standing:* **NAAC 'A' Grade** Accredited Central University.
 - *Metrics:* Secured **62% (Class First Division)**.
 - *Thesis Title:* "Factors facilitating outside students seeking admission in the central university of Haryana: A study of push and pull factors"
 - **B.Com** | Silver Jubilee Government College (**Autonomous**), Kurnool, AP, India (**2014 – 2017**)
 - *Metrics:* Secured **73%**.
 - **M.A. in Psychology** | Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU) | **Pursuing**
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GLOBAL THOUGHT LEADERSHIP (PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES)

Authored Scholarly Books

1. **Solmanraj, T., & Arshi, K.** (2023). *Domestic Violence in Rural India: A Study of a Village in Haryana*. New Delhi: Notion Press Publishing. **ISBN: 979-8890261595**.
2. **Solmanraj, T.** (2025). *A Hand Book on Sociology*. **ISBN: 979-8899292330**.
3. **Solmanraj, T.** (Forthcoming). *Sociology of Music: A Case Study on Dappu Instrument*.

Book Chapters

1. **Solmanraj, T.** (2023). "Widows of Vrindavan: A Study of Changing Family Structure and Function in India."
2. **Solmanraj, T.** (2023). "Role of Sulabh International Organization in Improving Sanitation, Hygiene and Health of the Widows of Vrindavan: A Sociological Study."
3. **Solmanraj, T.** (2020). "Problems of Dalit Women Accessing Water Resources." In Gunjan & S. Kumar (Eds.), *Gender Sensitive Education: A Necessity to Eradicate Gender Discrimination* (Serial No. 10). Ranchi: **NUSRL. ISBN: 978-93-5396-977-6.**

Peer-Reviewed Journals

1. **Solmanraj, T.** (2026). "Living Death in the City of Widows: A Mixed-Methods Study..." *OMEGA - Journal of Death and Dying* (SAGE Publications). [Under Press].
2. **Solmanraj, T.** (2023). "Sanitation and Water Access to Dalit Women in India." *International Journal of Research and Analytical Reviews (IJRAR)*, ISSN: 2348-1269.
3. **Solmanraj, T.** (2022). "Socio-Cultural Problems of Migrant Widows in India: Special Reference to Vrindavan City." *International Journal of Creative Research Thoughts (IJCRT)*, ISSN: 2320-2882.
4. **Solmanraj, T.** (2022). "Domestic Violence against Widows in India: Special Reference to Vrindavan City." *International Journal of Research and Analytical Reviews (IJRAR)*, ISSN: 2348-1269.
5. **Solmanraj, T.** (2022). "The Plight of Destitute and Migrant Widows in India: A Sociological Study of Vrindavan." *International Journal of Novel Research and Development (IJNRD)*, ISSN: 2456-418X.
6. Arshi, K., & **Solmanraj, T.** (2022). "The Positive Impact of Social Media on Students in India." *Shodh Disha*, ISSN: 0975-735X.

Selected Major Scholarly Presentations

1. **ISA Europe International Conference (2026): "Living Death and Digital Exclusion..."** [Paper Accepted – Peer-Reviewed].

2. **National Seminar, Constitution Club, New Delhi (2022):** *"Role of NGOs (Sulabh International) Among Widows of Vrindavan: A Sociological Study."*
 3. **ICSSR International Seminars (2025):** Key presentations delivered at **Banaras Hindu University (BHU), Varanasi** ("Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's Legacy") and Gorakhpur University ("The Digital Divide: A Feminist Perspective").
 4. **National Seminar, Magadh University (2023):** *"Changing Family Structure and Function: A Study of Vrindavan."*
 5. **International Conference, Madhya Pradesh (2023):** *"Widows of Vrindavan: A Study of Changing Family Structure and Function in India."*
 6. **ICHR Sponsored National Seminar (2022):** *"Roots of Democracy in Ancient India: Theories and Praxis."*
 7. **International Seminar, Lucknow (2020):** *"Educational Disruption in India during Covid-19."*
 8. **National Webinar, DAV P.G. College, BHU Varanasi (2020):** *"Corona Calamity: Problem of Migrant Workers During Nationwide Lockdown."*
 9. **National Seminar, Central University of South Bihar (CUSB), Gaya (2020):** *"Media Violence and Indian Youth."*
 10. **National Seminar, Central University of South Bihar (CUSB), Gaya (2020):** *"Rewriting Indian History: Problems of Widows in India."*
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NATIONAL FELLOWSHIPS & SCHOLASTIC MERITS

- **NFSC Fellow (2022-2025):** Conferred the prestigious **National Fellowship for Scheduled Castes** by the Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, **Govt. of India**.
- **4x UGC-NET Qualified:** Demonstrated elite-level national mastery of core sociological concepts through consistent competitive selection (**Cycles: Dec 2018, June 2019, Dec 2019, and Feb 2022**).

- **Advanced Methodological Training (2022):** Successfully completed the **ICSSR (Govt. of India)** sponsored Faculty Development Program on "*Statistical Tools in Research Methodology*" at St. Francis Institute of Management & Research, Mumbai.
 - **Guinness World Record Holder (2024):** Certified team participant in a globally recognized milestone achievement.
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SERVICE, CAPACITY BUILDING & CIVIC DUTY

- **Expert Reviewer:** Active expert manuscript reviewer for the *International Journal of Innovative Research in Technology (IJIRT)*.
 - **Social Awareness Engagement:** Participated in the **NISD** Sponsored Workshop on "*Transgender Policy Awareness and Social Equity*" at **CUSB Gaya** (2025).
 - **Civic Engagement: National Cadet Corps (NCC) 'A' Certificate Holder** (No. APJD/2009/267953, Under CDT Rank).
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PERSONAL DETAILS

- **Date of Birth:** 25/04/1996
 - **Nationality:** Indian
 - **Linguistic Assets:** **Telugu** (Native), **English** (Professional Working), **Hindi** (Professional Working)
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Declaration: I hereby certify that the information provided above is authentic, complete, and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Dr. Tekmal Solmanraj